

# Airliners Emerge

During the 1920s the airliner began to emerge as a viable means of transport. Although initial designs were loosely based on World War I strategic bombers, such as the Farman F4X, by the mid-1920s there were many specially built airliners operating all over the world. This decade also saw some fantastic flying machines, such as the giant Junkers G38 and the 12-engine Dornier Do-X flying boat.



## △ de Havilland DH18 1920

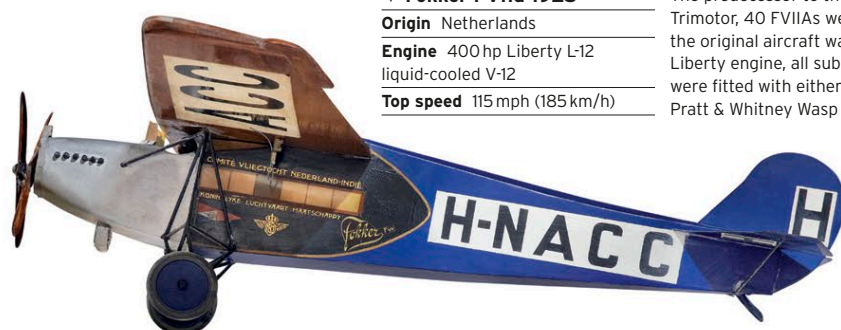
**Origin** UK  
**Engine** 450 hp Napier Lion  
 liquid-cooled 12-cylinder broad arrow  
**Top speed** 125 mph (200 km/h)

This large single-engine biplane was mostly used on the Croydon to Paris run. The type has the dubious distinction of being involved in the first airliner-to-airliner mid-air collision, when one collided with a Farman Goliath over northern France.

## ◁ Fokker FII 1920

**Origin** Germany/Netherlands  
**Engine** 250 hp Armstrong Siddeley Puma liquid-cooled in-line 6  
**Top speed** 93 mph (150 km/h)

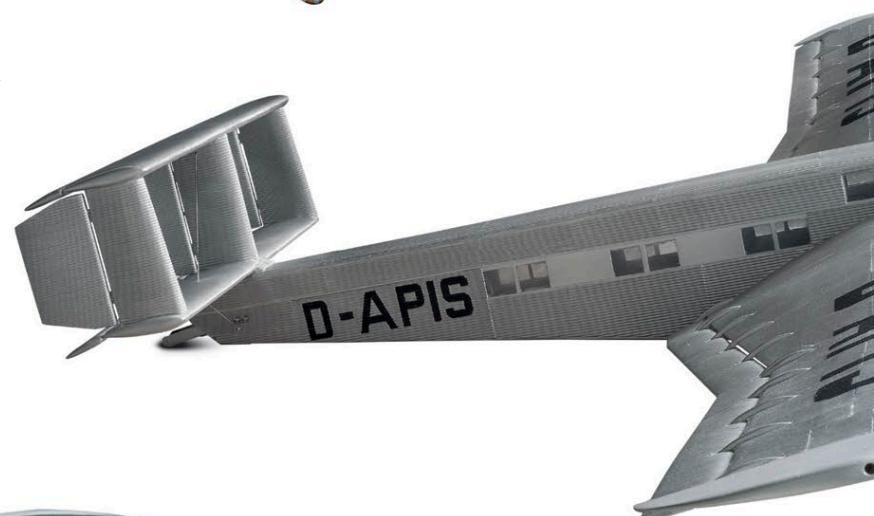
The Fokker FII drew heavily on the experience that Fokker gained with the DVIII monoplane fighter. At a time when most aeroplanes were biplanes, the FII looked very modern. An unusual feature is the lack of a vertical stabilizer or fin, with directional stability being provided solely by the deep, slab-sided fuselage.



## ▽ Fokker FVIIa 1925

**Origin** Netherlands  
**Engine** 400 hp Liberty L-12  
 liquid-cooled V-12  
**Top speed** 115 mph (185 km/h)

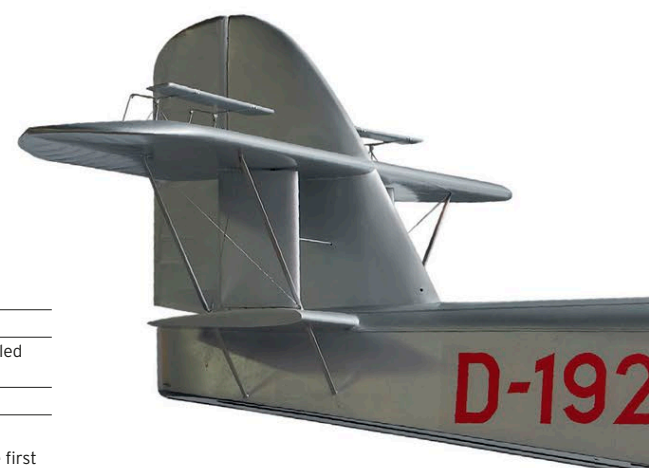
The predecessor to the successful Fokker Trimotor, 40 FVIIAs were built. Although the original aircraft was powered by a Liberty engine, all subsequent machines were fitted with either Bristol Jupiter or Pratt & Whitney Wasp radial engines.



## ▷ Fokker FVIIb/3M/FX 1925

**Origin** Netherlands/USA  
**Engine** 3 x 220 hp Wright J-5 Whirlwind  
 air-cooled 9-cylinder radial  
**Top speed** 115 mph (185 km/h)

Known as the Fokker Trimotor, this was a very popular airliner. Of Dutch design but powered by American engines, this is the enlarged FX built under license in the US. Sir Charles Kingsford-Smith made the first crossings of the Pacific Ocean and Tasman Sea, in an FVIIb called the Southern Cross.



## ◁ Handley Page Type W8 1921

**Origin** UK  
**Engine** 2 x 450 hp Napier Lion liquid-cooled  
 12-cylinder broad arrow  
**Top speed** 103 mph (166 km/h)

Handley Page's first specially built civil transport aircraft, is notable for being the first airliner to be designed with an integral toilet. As with many aircraft of the 1920s, it was somewhat underpowered with only two engines, and later models had an additional 360 hp Rolls-Royce Eagle V12 mounted in the nose.